

What is Edwards saying here?

1. We have no choice about
past facts.

2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of our future actions.

“1. I observed before, in explaining the nature of necessity, that in things which are past, their past existence is now necessary: having already made sure of existence, it is too late for any possibility of alteration in that respect ... ”

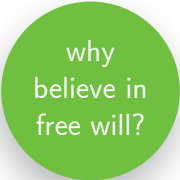
“2. If there be any such thing as a divine foreknowledge of the volitions of free agents, that foreknowledge ... is a thing which already has, and long ago had, existence; and so, now its existence is necessary.”



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out



1. We have no idea about

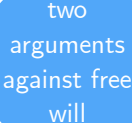
parasitiforms.



acai.iris.

22. In the past, God had

if we know the degree of our future



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

We'll shortly consider some ways of

first let's think about how Edwards'

for fatalsn.

argument might be related to an argument

responding to Edwards' argument. But

there were truths about all our future

Suppose that someone did not believe in

actions. Could they give an argument

similar to Edwards' argument?

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

God only shows up in premises (2) and

our future actions.

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

with reference to the being of truth about



1. We have no direct facts.

2*In the past, there were truths about

all of our activities.

God knows that in the future I will

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

perform a certain action (1,2)

then we have the choice about q.

(3, 4, 5)

some action, then I will prefer that

will perform various actions.

0 We have achieved what we

3 We have not the fact that

acaioid.

5* We have noticed that the fact

4. If we have no choice about p , and no



that if it is true that I will perform

The fatalist argument

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predict.

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

things as fate, then there is no free will.

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

freedom that comes from fate.





parasitiformis.

1. We have no choice about



2. In the past, God had

if we know the degree of our future

“1. I observed before, in explaining the nature of necessity, that in things which are past, their past existence is now necessary: having already made sure of existence, it is too late for any possibility of alteration in that respect ... ”

“2. If there be any such thing as a divine foreknowledge of the volitions of free agents, that foreknowledge ... is a thing which already has, and long ago had, existence; and so, now its existence is necessary.”